

FIRST DAY AT A NEW JOB CHECKLIST

The first day at a new job represents a pivotal transition, setting the foundation for future performance, relationships, and professional growth. A structured approach can ease uncertainty, promote confidence, and ensure that essential tasks and interactions are handled effectively. From preparing necessary documents and understanding organizational expectations to building early connections with colleagues, thoughtful planning helps transform an overwhelming experience into a productive and positive start. The following checklist outlines key actions designed to support a smooth and successful first day in any professional setting.

1 Before Your First Day

1.1 Confirm the Basics

- ☐ Start time and expected arrival (aim for 10–15 minutes early)
- ☐ Office location or remote login details
- ☐ Parking, building access, or security procedures
- ☐ Dress code (ask HR if unclear)

1.2 Review Company Information

- ☐ Revisit the company website
- ☐ Review mission, vision, and core values
- ☐ Skim recent news or announcements
- ☐ Review job description and responsibilities

1.3 Prepare Your Materials

- ☐ Government ID (if required)
- ☐ Banking info for payroll
- ☐ Notepad or digital note app
- ☐ List of prepared questions
- ☐ Lunch/snacks (if unsure of options nearby)

1.4 Mental Preparation

- ☐ Set realistic expectations (you won't know everything yet)
- ☐ Prepare a short self-introduction
- ☐ Plan 2–3 questions about your team and role
- ☐ Get a full night's sleep

2 During Your First Day

2.1 Arrival and First Impressions

- ☐ Arrive early
- ☐ Greet people confidently
- ☐ Introduce yourself clearly (name + role)
- ☐ Maintain positive body language

2.2 Orientation and HR Tasks

- ☐ Complete paperwork (tax, benefits, policies)
- ☐ Review employee handbook
- ☐ Set up email and required accounts
- ☐ Set up payroll and benefits
- ☐ Get ID badge, keys, or equipment

2.3 Meet Your Manager

- ☐ Ask questions
- ☐ Confirm reporting structure
- ☐ Clarify expectations
- ☐ Schedule recurring check-ins

2.4 Meet Your Team

- ☐ Learn names and roles
- ☐ Understand how your role supports theirs
- ☐ Ask what they're currently working on
- ☐ Take notes on key contacts

2.5 Understand Tools and Processes

- ☐ Learn core software platforms
- ☐ Understand communication channels (Slack, Teams, email)
- ☐ Ask about workflows and approvals
- ☐ Review ongoing projects

2.6 Observe Company Culture

- ☐ Notice how meetings are run
- ☐ Pay attention to decision-making patterns
- ☐ Note work pace and expectations
- ☐ Observe communication style (formal/informal)

3 After Work: Day-One Wrap-Up

3.1 Reflect

- ☐ What did you learn?
- ☐ Who are key stakeholders?
- ☐ What is still unclear?
- ☐ What are tomorrow's priorities?

3.2 Organize

- ☐ Clean up notes
- ☐ Send a thank-you or follow-up message (if appropriate)
- ☐ Create a task list for Day Two